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NOTES BY

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IITM BS · ENGLISH I · WEEKS 1 – 4

Full Qualifier Notes

+ 109 Solved PYQs

109	92	9
PYQs solved	most repeated	official papers

1 **Week 1 · Sounds and Words** — 28 PYQs — pp. 2–11

2 **Week 2 · Parts of Speech** — 28 PYQs — pp. 12–21

3 **Week 3 · Sentences, Phrases & Idioms** — 28 PYQs — pp. 22–31

4 **Week 4 · Spoken English Basics** — 25 PYQs — pp. 32–42

HOW TO USE

Read the diagram notes, solve the week's PYQs, then check the answer table. Most repeated questions come first.

WEEK 1 · SOUNDS AND WORDS

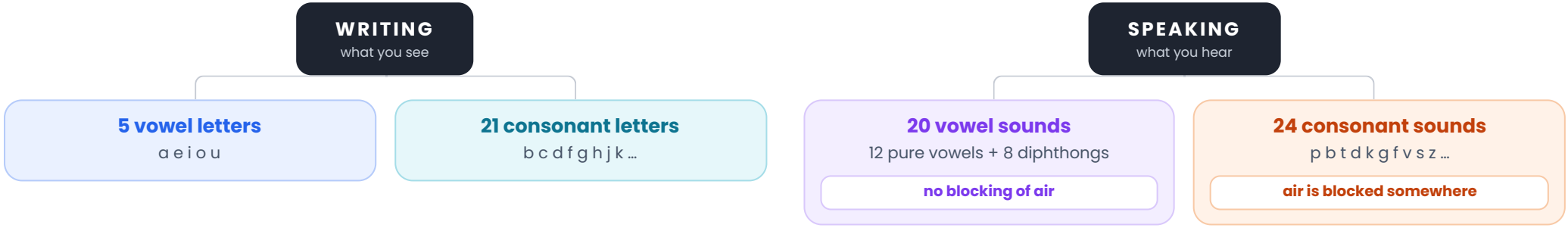
Sounds and Words

1

English is spelt one way and spoken another. This week teaches you to **hear** words: the sounds (vowels, diphthongs, semi-vowels, consonants), how sounds join into **clusters** and **syllables**, and how the plural **-s** really sounds.

1.1 Letters are not sounds

We **write** English with 26 letters, but we **speak** it with about 44 sounds. Exam questions are almost always about the **sound**, never about the letter. Keep these two worlds apart from day one.



Two different systems — 26 letters on paper, about 44 sounds in the mouth (standard British English)

Word	Letters say…	Sound says…
hour	starts with consonant **h**	starts with a **vowel** sound → **an** hour
university	starts with vowel **u**	starts with **/y/** (yoo) → **a** university
knit	4 letters, starts with k	3 sounds **n-i-t** (k is silent)
phone	p + h	one sound **/f/**

EASY WAY TO REMEMBER

Eyes lie, ears don't. Before you answer any sound question, say the word aloud (softly) and listen. Count and compare **sounds**, not letters. Silent letters (k in *knit*, h in *hour*) do not exist for the ear.

1.2 How vowels and consonants are made

VOWEL

Air comes out **freely**. Nothing blocks it. Vocal cords always vibrate (voiced). Shape changes come from lips, jaw and tongue height.

a, ii, uu, oo, aa …

SEMI-VOWEL

Made like a vowel (no blocking) but **behaves like a consonant** in a word. Only two in English.

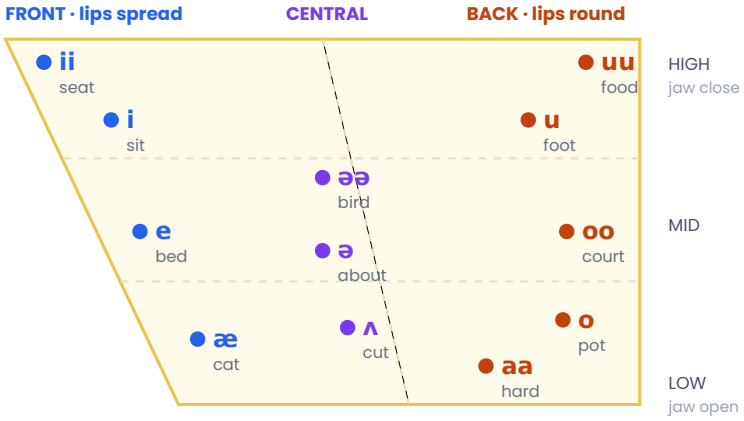
/w/ as in wet · /y/ as in yet

CONSONANT

Air is **blocked or squeezed** somewhere — lips, teeth, ridge, palate or throat. Can be voiced or voiceless.

p, b, t, d, s, z, k, g …

1.3 The 12 pure vowels (monophthongs)



Where the tongue sits for each vowel. Left = front of mouth, right = back.

Short	Long partner	Hear the difference
i — sit, pit, knit	**ii** — seat, peat, neat	*ship / sheep*
u — foot, put, pull	**uu** — food, root, blue	*full / fool*
o — pot, hot	**oo** — court, board, sport	*cot / caught*
ʌ — cut, but	**aa** — hard, part, car	*cut / cart*
ə — about, sofa	**əə** — bird, word	*the weak vowel*
e — bed, wet	**æ** — cat, pack	*bed / bad*

WHY THIS MATTERS

English long vowels are **very long** — almost twice an Indian long vowel. Long vs short changes the word (*pill / peel*). In the exam, "long vowel /uu/" = the sound in **through, blue, too, flew** — all four spellings, one sound.

1.4 Diphthongs — one vowel that glides into another

A **diphthong** is an extra-long vowel: the tongue **starts at one vowel and slides to another** inside one syllable. Say *boy* slowly: o → i. That slide is the test. English has 8.

/ai/ a → i	/ei/ e → i	/oi/ o → i	/au/ a → u	/əu/ ə → u	/iə/ i → ə	/eə/ e → ə	/uə/ u → ə
buy, ply, bite	bail, clay, maiden	boy, boycott, loiter	how, mouth, gown, brow	go, foe, flow, boat	near, dear, ear	hair, care, pear	poor, tour

Blue: glide to **i** · Purple: glide to **u** · Teal: glide to **ə** (the centring diphthongs)

Looks like a diphthong…	but is a pure long vowel
sport, court, board	**oo** — no slide
moot, stew, clue, root	**uu** — no slide
seat, meet, wheat	**ii** — no slide

TRAP: SAME LETTERS, DIFFERENT SOUND

ow in *brow, gown, brown* = /au/ but in *flow, foe* = /əu/. Spelling does not decide. Say it.

1.5 Semi-vowels /w/ and /y/ — the hidden glue

When a word ending in a vowel meets a word starting with a vowel, English slips in a tiny glide so the two vowels do not crash.

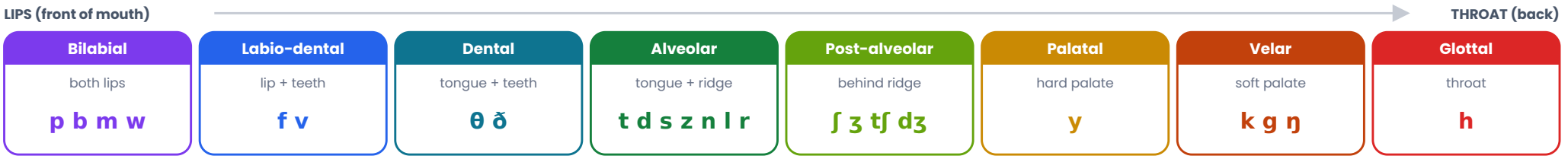
she ends in **ii** (front)	→	**+ /y/ +** front vowel → y	→	**offered**
go ends in **əu** (rounded)	→	**+ /w/ +** round vowel → w	→	**out**

RULE IN ONE LINE

After **i / ii / ei / ai** (lips spread) → **/y/**: *he arrived, me off, she actually*. After **u / uu / əu / au** (lips round) → **/w/**: *go out, do it, who is*. Inside a word: *quiet* = k**w**aiət → /w/.

1.6 Consonants — where and how the air is blocked

Every consonant is described by three questions: **Where** is the air blocked (place)? **How** is it blocked (manner)? Do the vocal cords **vibrate** (voice)?



Place of articulation — move from the lips to the throat. Sounds made at the same place are 'family'.

Manner	What happens	Sounds
Stop / plosive	full block, then a burst	p b t d k g
Fricative	air squeezed — hissing friction	f v θ ð s z ʃ ʒ h
Affricate	stop + fricative together	tʃ (church) dʒ (judge)
Nasal	air goes out through the nose	m n ŋ (sing)
Lateral / approximant	air flows round the tongue / glide	l, r, w, y

Voiceless (no buzz)	Voiced (buzz)	Pair example
p	b	*pin / bin*
t	d	*temple / tumble*
k	g	*uncle / angle*
f	v	*fan / van*
s	z	*sip / zip*
ʃ (ship)	ʒ (vision)	*pressure / measure*

THE FINGER TEST

Put a finger on your throat. Say **sss**, then **zzz**. The buzz you feel in **zzz** is voicing. **s, f, p, t, k, h** = no buzz. **z, v, b, d, g** = buzz. All vowels buzz.

PYQ TRAPS

vision, azure, measure all have **/ʒ/**; *prison* has plain **/z/** — the odd one. **v** (lip on teeth: *van*) ≠ **w** (round lips: *wan, queen*).

1.7 Words are chains of C and V — and clusters

Write every word as a chain of **C** (consonant sound) and **V** (vowel sound). Two or more consonant sounds side by side, with **no vowel between**, form a **consonant cluster**.

Word	Sounds	Pattern	Cluster?
dad	d-a-d	CVC	none
glass	g-l-aa-s	**CC**VC	initial CC (gl)
sink	s-i-ŋ-k	CV**CC**	final CC (ŋk)
exhibit	e-g-z-i-b-i-t	V**CC**VCVC	medial CC (gz) — x = two sounds
spring	s-p-r-i-ŋ	**CCC**VC	initial CCC (spr)
eye	ai	V	only a vowel sound

Initial CC
flip, glass, bliss, class, school, blast
2 consonants at the start

Initial CCC
spring, sprout, stress, screw, splash, string
always begins with s + p/t/k + l/r/w

Final CC
jump (mp), sink (ŋk), blast (st), help (lp)
2 consonants at the end

Final CCC
against (nst), next (kst), months (nθs)
3 consonants at the end

The four cluster types tested in exams — position (initial / final) × size (CC / CCC)

CLUSTER RULES

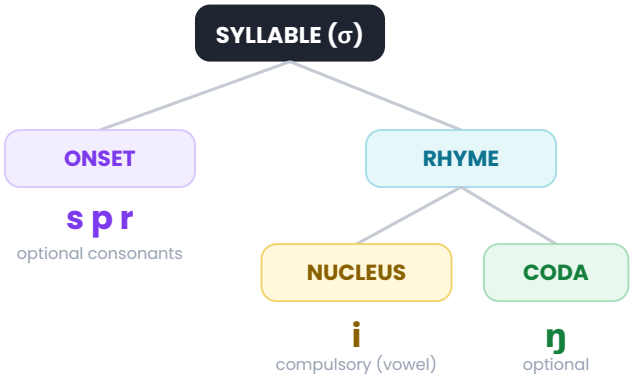
1. Count **sounds**: *knit* has no cluster (k is silent); *phone* starts with one sound /f/.
2. A 3-consonant start in English **always begins with s**.
3. Sounds from the same place rarely sit together (no word starts with *pb-* or *td-*).

EXAM METHOD

Say the word in slow motion, tap one finger per sound, mark V on vowel taps. Then read the C-V string: **where** is the CC/CCC and **how many** Cs?

1.8 Syllables — the beats of a word

A **syllable** is one beat of speech built around **one vowel sound** (the nucleus). Consonants before it are the **onset**; after it, the **coda**. Nucleus + coda = **rhyme**.



One-syllable word *spring*: onset spr · nucleus i · coda ŋ

Beats	Word → split	Count
1	sun · life · break · tongue	1
2	ti-ger · po-lice · ex-tract	2
3	e-ner-gy · re-pen-tance · tre-men-dous	3
4	e-du-ca-tion · en-tre-pre-neur · com-pen-sa-tion	4
5	im-ple-men-ta-tion	5

COUNTING TRICK

Count the **vowel sounds** you hear, not vowel letters. Put your hand under your chin — each time the jaw drops is one syllable. A diphthong is still **one** beat (*buy* = 1).

1.9 How the plural -s sounds: [s], [z] or [iz]

Look at the LAST SOUND
of the singular word (not the last letter)

→

Hissing sound?
s z ʃ ʒ tʃ dʒ
dish, bench, judge, bus
→ [iz] dishes, judges

→

Voiceless sound?
p t k f θ
book, cap, landscape
→ [s] books, landscapes

→

Anything else
voiced consonant or any vowel
dog, lemon, factory
→ [z] dogs, lemons, factories

WHY IT WORKS

The plural marker is really **/z/**. Next to a voiceless sound (p, t, k) it loses its buzz and becomes **/s/**. After a hissing sound it needs an extra vowel to be heard → **/iz/**. So *meetings, discussions, presentations* = /z/, /z/, /z/ (they end in ŋ, n, n — all voiced).

Week 1 · Real PYQs (most repeated first)

28 questions from official IITM papers — qualifier, quiz and end term. Solve all, then check the answer table. The orange tag shows how many times that question **type** has appeared.

1 **Which among the following words has a diphthong?**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Bottle
- B. Boycott
- C. Bail
- D. Both Boycott and Bail

2 **Which among the following is a word without a diphthong?**

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Snout
- B. Stout
- C. Sport
- D. Shout

3 **Which among the following is a word without a diphthong?**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Mouth
- B. South
- C. Pout
- D. Moot

4 **Which among the following is a word without a diphthong?**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Ply
- B. Clay
- C. Buy
- D. Clue

5 **Which semi-vowel occurs in the transition between the words “go” and “out” in the sentence “go out”?**

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. /w/
- B. /y/

6 **Which semi-vowel occurs in the transition between the words ‘she’ and ‘offered’ in the sentence ‘she offered to help me with my assignment’?**

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. /w/
- B. /y/

7 **Which semi-vowel does the word “quiet” contain?**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. /w/
- B. /y/

8 **Pick the odd one out on the basis of the similarity of sounds: knit, pit, kit, neat**

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 5× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Knit
- B. Pit
- C. Kit
- D. Neat

9 **Pick the odd one out based on the initial sound: near, dear, tear, gear.**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 5× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Near
- B. Dear
- C. Tear
- D. Gear

10 **Pick the odd one out based on the initial sound: peat, beat, clear, pear.**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 5× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Peat
- B. Beat
- C. Clear
- D. Pear

11 **In which word does the underlined part have a different sound?**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Vision
- B. Azure
- C. Measure
- D. Prison

12 **Which among the following carry the long vowel /uu/?**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Through
- B. Blue
- C. Too
- D. Flew
- E. All of these

13 **Choose the word with an “aa” sound from the following.**

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Hoard
- B. Board
- C. Hard
- D. Teeth

14 **Choose the word with an “u” sound from the following.**

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Root
- B. Foot
- C. Court
- D. Both Root and Foot

15 **Choose the word with an "oo" sound from the following.**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Court ○ **B.** Loot ○ **C.** Cat ○ **D.** Feat

16 **Which among the following words has the same sound as underlined in "foe"?**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Gown ○ **B.** Flow ○ **C.** Brow ○ **D.** Brown

17 **Which of the given consonant-vowel sequences correctly illustrates the consonant cluster/clusters in the word exhibit?**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** VCCCVCVC ○ **B.** VCCVCVC ○ **C.** VCCVCCVC ○ **D.** VCVCVC

18 **The consonant cluster in the word flip is an instance of _____.**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Initial CC ○ **B.** Final CC ○ **C.** Initial CCC ○ **D.** Final CCC

19 **The consonant cluster in the word jump is an instance of _____.**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Initial CC ○ **B.** Final CC ○ **C.** Initial CCC ○ **D.** Final CCC

20 **The consonant cluster in the word sprout is an instance of _____.**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Initial CC ○ **B.** Final CC ○ **C.** Initial CCC ○ **D.** Final CCC

21 **The consonant cluster in the word against is an instance of _____.**

End Term · Apr 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Initial CC ○ **B.** Final CC ○ **C.** Initial CCC ○ **D.** Final CCC

22 **The word 'entrepreneur' has _____ syllables.**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** 2 ○ **B.** 3 ○ **C.** 4

23 **How many syllables are there in the word Implementation?**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** 3 ○ **B.** 4 ○ **C.** 6 ○ **D.** 5

24 **How many syllables are there in the word tremendous?**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** 3 ○ **B.** 4 ○ **C.** 5 ○ **D.** 6

25 **In the plural noun dishes, the plural marker sounds as _____.**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 5× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** [s] ○ **B.** [z] ○ **C.** [iz]

26 **In the plural noun landscapes, the plural marker sounds as _____.**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 5× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** [s] ○ **B.** [z] ○ **C.** [iz]

27 **In the plural noun factories, the plural marker sounds as _____.**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 5× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** [s] ○ **B.** [z] ○ **C.** [iz]

28 **The plural markers for the words 'meetings', 'discussions', and 'presentations' are _____.**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 5× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** /z/, /z/, and /z/ respectively ○ **B.** /s/, /s/, and /s/ respectively ○ **C.** /z/, /z/, and /s/ respectively

● HOW WEEK 1 IS TESTED

Sound questions are **1 mark each** and come in fixed shapes: **with/without a diphthong**, **which semi-vowel**, **odd one out by sound**, **same vowel sound**, **cluster type**, **syllable count** and **plural marker**. Learn the 7 shapes and these are free marks. Always say the word aloud in your head before choosing.

Answers & reasons: Week 1

Q	Correct option	Why	See
1	D Both Boycott and Bail	Boycott has /oi/ and bail has /ei/ — both glide. Bottle has short pure vowels.	§1.4
2	C Sport	Snout, stout, shout all have /au/. *Sport* has the long pure vowel oo — no glide.	§1.4
3	D Moot	Mouth, south, pout = /au/. *Moot* = long uu, no glide.	§1.4
4	D Clue	Ply, buy = /ai/; clay = /ei/. *Clue* = long uu — pure vowel.	§1.4
5	A /w/	*go* ends in rounded /əu/, so a /w/ glide joins it to *out*.	§1.5
6	B /y/	*she* ends in front vowel ii → /y/ glide.	§1.5
7	A /w/	quiet = k**w**aiət. The qu- spelling hides a /w/.	§1.5
8	D Neat	knit, pit, kit share the short vowel i. *Neat* has long ii.	§1.3
9	D Gear	n, d, t are all made at the alveolar ridge. *g* is velar (back of mouth).	§1.6
10	C Clear	p and b are bilabial (lips). *Clear* starts with velar k.	§1.6
11	D Prison	vision, azure, measure have /ʒ/. Prison has /z/.	§1.6
12	E All of these	through, blue, too, flew — four spellings, one long vowel /uu/.	§1.3
13	C Hard	*hard* = aa. Hoard, board = oo; teeth = ii.	§1.3
14	B Foot	*foot* = short u. Root = long uu; court = oo.	§1.3
15	A Court	*court* = long oo. Loot = uu; cat = æ; feat = ii.	§1.3
16	B Flow	foe and flow both have /əu/. Gown, brow, brown = /au/.	§1.4
17	B VCCVCVC	e-g-z-i-b-i-t: the letter x gives two sounds g+z → V**CC**VCVC.	§1.7
18	A Initial CC	fl- at the start: two consonants → initial CC.	§1.7
19	B Final CC	-mp at the end → final CC.	§1.7
20	C Initial CCC	spr- at the start → initial CCC (s + p + r).	§1.7
21	D Final CCC	-nst at the end → final CCC.	§1.7
22	C 4	en-tre-pre-neur = 4 vowel sounds.	§1.8
23	D 5	im-ple-men-ta-tion = 5 beats.	§1.8
24	A 3	tre-men-dous = 3 beats.	§1.8
25	C [iz]	dish ends in hissing /ʃ/ → [iz].	§1.9
26	A [s]	landscape ends in voiceless /p/ → [s].	§1.9
27	B [z]	factory ends in a vowel (voiced) → [z].	§1.9
28	A /z/, /z/, and /z/ respectively	All three end in voiced ŋ / n → /z/ each time.	§1.9

WEEK 1 · REVISION

Everything in Week 1, on one page

The night-before page. If you can rebuild these from memory, Week 1 is done.

R

1 Core vocabulary

Vowel	voiced sound, air not blocked (12 pure)
Diphthong	vowel that glides to another in one syllable (8)
Semi-vowel	/w/ and /y/ — vowel-like, act as consonants
Consonant	air blocked somewhere; voiced or voiceless
Cluster	2–3 consonant sounds with no vowel between
Syllable	one beat around one vowel sound
Plural marker	[s] after voiceless, [iz] after hissing, [z] elsewhere

2 The traps examiners love

● FIVE TRAPS

1. sport, court, moot, clue, stew = pure long vowels, **no** diphthong.
2. ow: brow/gown = /au/ but flow/foe = /əu/.
3. she/he/me + vowel → /y/; go/do/who + vowel → /w/.
4. exhibit = VCCVCVC (x = g+z). Initial CCC always starts with s.
5. Count syllables by vowel **sounds**; plural by the last **sound**.

3 The whole week as one map

SOUNDS 44 in English → **Vowels** 12 pure + 8 diphthongs → **Semi-vowels** /w/ /y/ glides → **Consonants** place · manner · voice → **Words** C-V chains, clusters → **Syllables** onset · nucleus · coda → **Plural sound** [s] [z] [iz]

WEEK 2 · PARTS OF SPEECH

Parts of Speech

2

Every word in a sentence has a **job**. The name of that job is its **part of speech**. This week covers all eight — noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, conjunction, interjection — plus the articles **a / an / the**.

2.1 Eight jobs a word can do

NOUN
names a person, place, thing, idea
Arjun, Greece, love

PRONOUN
replaces a noun
he, it, they, their

VERB
shows action or state
play, is, think

ADJECTIVE
describes a noun
big, red, ripe

ADVERB
describes verb / adjective / adverb
slowly, very, now

PREPOSITION
shows relation of time, place, direction
in, on, at, into

CONJUNCTION
joins words, phrases, clauses
and, but, because

INTERJECTION
shows sudden feeling
Wow! Ouch! Oops!

Blue = naming words · Red = the action · Purple = describing words · Teal = linking words · Orange = feeling words. Articles a / an / the sit with nouns.

THE GOLDEN RULE

A word's part of speech depends on **what it does in this sentence**, not on the word itself. The same word can do different jobs.

Sentence	light is a...
Switch on the **light**.	noun (a thing)
Please **light** the lamp.	verb (an action)
This bag is **light**.	adjective (describes bag)

EXAM METHOD FOR "IDENTIFY THE PART OF SPEECH"

Ask the word one question:
Does it name? → noun · **Does it stand for a noun?** → pronoun · **Is it the action/state?** → verb · **Does it tell which/what kind of noun?** → adjective · **Does it tell how/when/where?** → adverb · **Does it link?** → preposition/conjunction.

2.2 Nouns — naming words

NOUN
person · place · thing · animal · feeling · idea

Countable
can say one, two, three...

Proper noun
one particular name — *John, Patna, Sunday, India*

Common / class noun
any member of a class — *cat, tiger, house, hill*

Collective noun
a group seen as one — *jury, police, cabinet, team*

Uncountable
cannot count one by one

Abstract noun
an idea you cannot touch — *goodness, youth, poverty, freedom, success*

Material noun
a substance — *gold, water, rice, wheat*

THE TOUCH TEST
Touch / see / hear it? → **concrete** (*mountain, table*).
Only think or feel it? → **abstract** (*love, freedom*).
Parliament is real → **not** abstract.

Also tested
labels by form and meaning

Compound noun
two words, one noun — *swimming pool, toothpaste, bookshop*

Concrete noun
a real, physical thing — *mountain, book, teacher*

Gerund (-ing noun)
-ing word naming an activity — ***Swimming*** *is good exercise.*

2.3 Pronouns — words that stand in for nouns

Rahul went to Kerala with Rahul's mother. Rahul enjoyed time with Rahul's mother. → *Rahul went to Kerala with **his** mother. **He** enjoyed time with **her**.* Pronouns stop this boring repetition.

Subject (does)	Object (receives)	Possessive	Others
I, we	me, us	my, our, mine	this, that
you	you	your, yours	these, those
he, she, it, they	him, her, it, them	his, her, its, their	who, which, someone

PYQ NOTE
In IITM papers **their**, **they**, **it** are all marked **pronoun**. *"Their fans were very disappointed"* → pronoun. *"The bread was stale; it had been left outside"* → pronoun (it = the bread).

2.4 Verbs — the engine of the sentence

Every sentence needs a verb
Go! is a full sentence — one verb, hidden subject *you*.

→

Only verbs carry tense
past · present · future

→

Action or state
plays (action) · *is, has* (state)

VERBS

Main verb
carries the meaning
*Riyad **plays** cricket.*

Auxiliary (helping) verb
helps the main verb: tense, question, negative
*She **is** singing. **Do** you know?*

Auxiliary family	Forms
be	am, is, are, was, were, being, been
have	have, has, had, having
do	do, does, did
modals	can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, would

Subject	be (now)	be (past)	have	action verb (now)
I	am	was	have	I **play**
He / She / It / Riyad	is	was	has	he **plays** (+s)
We / You / They	are	were	have	they **play**

2.5 Adjectives — describing nouns

An adjective tells **which, what kind, how many** about a noun: *She drives an **amazing big red sports** car.* When you stack adjectives, keep the order:

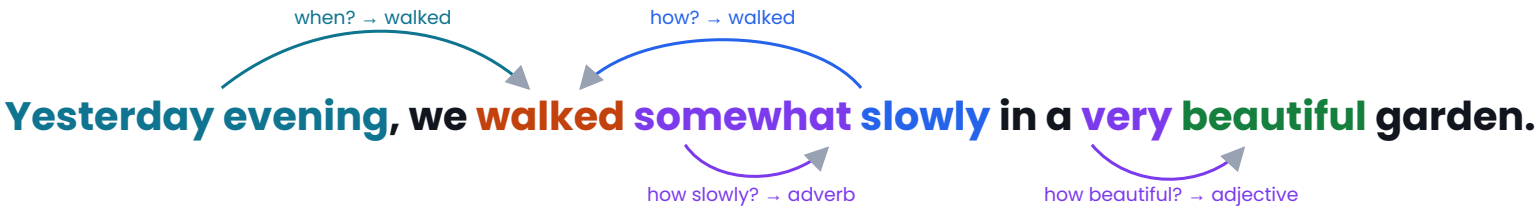
Opinion amazing → **Size** big → **Colour** red → **Type** sports → **NOUN** car

Degree	Use	Example
Positive	no comparison	tall · good · clear
Comparative	2 things, + **than**	taller · better · **clearer**
Superlative	3 or more, + **the**	the tallest · the best

● **TRAP**
Never double it: ~~more clearer~~, ~~most clearest~~ → **clearer**, **clearest**. "Out of **all** the girls … Tina was the **tallest**" (group → superlative).

2.6 Adverbs — describing the action (and more)

An adverb adds information to a **verb**, an **adjective** or another **adverb**. It answers **how? when? where? how often? how much?**



Manner — how?
quickly, carefully, fluently, well

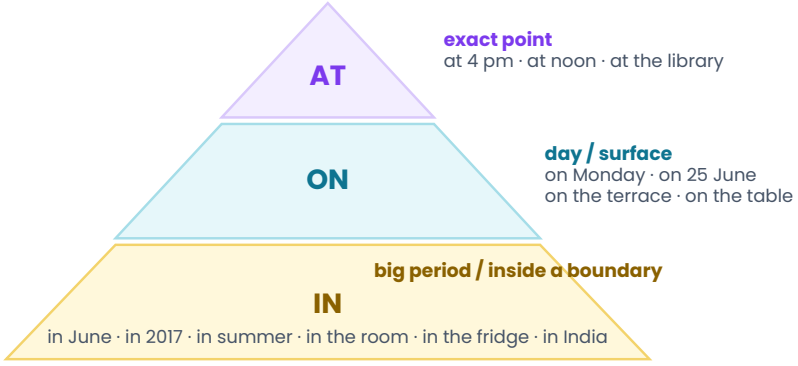
Time — when?
yesterday, now, today, immediately

Place — where?
here, abroad, outside, there

Frequency — how often?
daily, always, often, never

Degree — how much?
very, too, quite, extremely, somewhat

2.7 Prepositions — time and place



At → On → In: from the smallest point to the biggest space or period

Use	Preposition	Example
point in time (since when)	**since**	not read anything **since** Monday
length of time	**for**	**for** three days
movement inside	**into**	fell **into** a ditch · look **into** the matter
direction	**towards, across, up**	**across** the street
agent / means	**by**	built **by** a carpenter · travel **by** bus
topic	**about**	worried **about** the exam
position in a line	**ahead of, before**	standing in line **ahead of** me

Fixed partners — learn these as one unit

allergic to	good at	fond of	afraid of	proud of
worried about	look into	in my opinion	ahead of	against the wall
busy at work	the ruin of	luxury in our home	responsible for	according to

2.8 Conjunctions — joiners

A conjunction joins words (*Jack **and** Jill*), phrases (*intelligent **but** quiet*) or clauses (*You can cook, **or** you can clean*).

COORDINATING
join equal parts — **FANBOYS**
for · and · nor · but · or · yet · so

She tried **and** succeeded.

SUBORDINATING
join a smaller clause to a main clause
although · because · if · since · unless · until · while · as

Unless he helps, we cannot succeed.

CORRELATIVE
come in pairs
either…or · neither…nor · both…and · not only…but also · whether…or

neither tasty **nor** nutritious

Conjunction	Meaning	Example
but / yet	contrast	He may be poor **but** his character is faultless.
since	from a past time / because	I have been here **since** the sun rose.
unless	if not	**Unless** you study, you will fail.
lest	for fear that	I watched closely, **lest** he make a mistake.
no sooner…than	immediately after	**No sooner** had I reached **than** the bus came.

2.9 Interjections — sudden feeling

Wow!
surprise, amazement

Ouch!
pain

Oops!
small mistake, regret

Er… / Um…
hesitation, doubt

Hi! / Hey!
greeting

Argh!
frustration

Interjections stand apart from the sentence, take no tense or number, and are common in speech.

2.10 Articles — a, an, the (and no article)

Is the noun specific / known / unique?
the reader knows which one

→

YES → THE
the sun · the best cake · the Himalayas · the book you gave me

→

NO, singular countable → A / AN
decide by the **first sound**

→

NO, general plural / uncountable → no article
Ants are industrious. Gold is costly.

A or AN?
listen to the first SOUND

A + consonant sound
a laptop · a cup · a cold day · **a university** (yoo) · a one-way road

AN + vowel sound
an emergency · an apple · **an hour** (h silent) · an MBA (em)

PYQ: WHY "AN HOUR"?
Because **hour** begins with a **vowel sound** — not because of the letter. That is the official answer.

Use THE before…	Example
something already mentioned / known	I saw a snake. **The** snake was a cobra.
one-of-a-kind things	**The** Sun rises in **the** east.
superlatives	This is **the** best cake I've ever had.
rivers, seas, mountain ranges, groups of islands	**the** Ganga, **the** Himalayas, **the** mountains
newspapers, holy / classic books	**the** Hindu, **the** Mahabharata
noun + of	**the** front of my house
the + comparative … the + comparative	**the** sooner, **the** better

ZERO ARTICLE
No article for routine places used for their purpose — *go **home**, to **church**, to **hospital**, to **bed**, to **college*** — and for general plural or abstract nouns: *Boys will be boys. The child needs care.*

Week 2 · Real PYQs (most repeated first)

28 questions from official IITM papers. Parts of speech, articles and prepositions together give about **10–12 marks** in every qualifier — the biggest grammar block.

1 **Identify the part of speech of the underlined word.**
She <u>yelled</u> when she hit her toe.

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Verb
- **B.** Noun
- **C.** Conjunction
- **D.** Adverb

2 **Identify the part of speech of the underlined word.**
Amy bought <u>ripe</u> tomatoes at the store.

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Noun
- **B.** Adjective
- **C.** Pronoun
- **D.** Verb

3 **Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:**
<u>Their</u> fans were very disappointed after the loss in the finals.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Noun
- **B.** Pronoun
- **C.** Verb
- **D.** Conjunction

4 **Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:**
"The <u>dog</u> ran into the glass door."

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Noun
- **B.** Pronoun
- **C.** Verb
- **D.** Conjunction

5 **Identify the part of speech of the underlined word:**
"The bread was stale; <u>it</u> had been left outside overnight."

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Noun
- **B.** Pronoun
- **C.** Verb
- **D.** Conjunction

6 **Select the option which identifies the noun in the sentence:**
Shraddha is a brilliant student.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 3× MULTIPLE ANSWERS

- **A.** Brilliant
- **B.** Is
- **C.** Student
- **D.** Shraddha

7 **Which of the following is NOT an Abstract Noun?**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Goodness
- **B.** Youth
- **C.** Poverty
- **D.** Parliament

8 **Identify the type of noun that is highlighted in the sentence.**
The swimming pool is drained and cleaned every winter.

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Collective
- **B.** Abstract
- **C.** Proper
- **D.** Compound

9 **'Rinku reads quite clearly'. In this sentence which of the following is an adverb?**

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 3× MULTIPLE ANSWERS

- **A.** Reads
- **B.** Quite
- **C.** Clearly
- **D.** Rinku

10 **Identify the adverb of manner:**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 3× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Here
- **B.** Now
- **C.** Quickly
- **D.** Very

11 **Identify the sentence with an adverb of place:**

End Term · Apr 2025 TYPE SEEN 3× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** He arrived late.
- **B.** The child played happily.
- **C.** They moved abroad.
- **D.** She sang beautifully.

12 **"I reached Chennai yesterday." The word "yesterday" is an adverb of ____.**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 3× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Time
- **B.** Place
- **C.** Frequency
- **D.** None of these

13 **Choose the correct option:**
"Out of all the girls in the basketball team, Tina was the _____."

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Taller
- **B.** Tallest

14 **Choose the correct sentence.**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Her explanation was clearer more after the revision.
- **B.** Her explanation was most clearest after the revision.
- **C.** Her explanation was more clearer after the revision.
- **D.** Her explanation was clearer after the revision.

15 **Identify the conjunction in the following sentence:**
"The food at the canteen was neither tasty nor nutritious."

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 3× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Food ○ **B.** Canteen ○ **C.** Tasty ○ **D.** Neither/nor

16 **She has not read anything_____ Monday.**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** For ○ **B.** Since ○ **C.** From ○ **D.** Over

17 **Choose the appropriate option:**
"I couldn't reach Chennai on time; my car fell ____ a ditch."

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Onto ○ **B.** Above ○ **C.** Into ○ **D.** About

18 **Choose the appropriate option:**
When I finally reached the ticket counter, John was already standing in line _____ of me.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Ahead ○ **B.** Above ○ **C.** Against ○ **D.** Across

19 **Choose the appropriate option.**
Sushma is worried _____ the exam.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** In ○ **B.** About ○ **C.** On ○ **D.** Of

20 **Choose the sentence with the correct preposition.**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 3× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** She is allergic of cats. ○ **B.** She is allergic with cats.
○ **C.** She is allergic to cats. ○ **D.** She is allergic by cats.

21 **Which sentence uses an incorrect preposition?**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 3× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** He's afraid of dogs. ○ **B.** She's good at math.
○ **C.** They're fond with dogs. ○ **D.** We're proud of our team.

22 **They usually spend their holidays in _____mountains.**

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** A ○ **B.** The ○ **C.** No article ○ **D.** An

23 **Choose the correct option:**
There is _____ emergency exit to your left.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** A ○ **B.** An ○ **C.** The ○ **D.** None of these

24 **Choose the correct option:**
This is _____ best chocolate cake I've ever had.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** A ○ **B.** An ○ **C.** The ○ **D.** None of these

25 **Choose the correct option:**
___ Sun rises in the east.

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 8× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** A ○ **B.** An ○ **C.** The ○ **D.** None of these

26 **"an hour"**
Why is 'an' used instead of 'a'?

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 2× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** "Hour" begins with a vowel letter
○ **B.** "Hour" begins with a vowel sound
○ **C.** It's an exception to the rule
○ **D.** Both "Hour" begins with a vowel letter and "Hour" begins with a vowel sound

27 **Choose the appropriate option:**
____! Stop pulling my hair!

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 2× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Wow ○ **B.** Oops ○ **C.** Ouch ○ **D.** Hi

28 **Which interjection expresses hesitation or uncertainty?**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 2× SINGLE ANSWER

○ **A.** Aha! ○ **B.** Er... ○ **C.** Whoa! ○ **D.** Yay!

Answers & reasons: Week 2

Q	Correct option	Why	See
1	**A** Verb	*yelled* is the action done by *she* → verb.	§2.4
2	**B** Adjective	*ripe* tells what kind of tomatoes → adjective.	§2.5
3	**B** Pronoun	*Their* stands for the team's name → pronoun (possessive).	§2.3
4	**A** Noun	*dog* names an animal → noun.	§2.2
5	**B** Pronoun	*it* replaces *the bread* → pronoun.	§2.3
6	**C, D** Student + Shraddha	Both *Shraddha* (proper) and *student* (common) are nouns. Two answers.	§2.2
7	**D** Parliament	Goodness, youth, poverty are ideas. *Parliament* is a real institution.	§2.2
8	**D** Compound	*swimming pool* = two words acting as one noun → compound.	§2.2
9	**B, C** Quite + Clearly	*clearly* tells how he reads; *quite* tells how clearly. Both adverbs.	§2.6
10	**C** Quickly	*quickly* = how → manner. Here = place, now = time, very = degree.	§2.6
11	**C** They moved abroad.	*abroad* answers where → place.	§2.6
12	**A** Time	*yesterday* answers when → time.	§2.6
13	**B** Tallest	Out of all the girls = a group → superlative *tallest*.	§2.5
14	**D** Her explanation was clearer after the revision.	One comparative only: *clearer*. No double forms.	§2.5
15	**D** Neither/nor	neither…nor is a correlative conjunction pair.	§2.8
16	**B** Since	Monday is a starting point in the past → *since*.	§2.7
17	**C** Into	movement to the inside of something → *into*.	§2.7
18	**A** Ahead	position in a queue → *ahead of*.	§2.7
19	**B** About	worried **about** — fixed partner.	§2.7
20	**C** She is allergic to cats.	allergic **to** — fixed partner.	§2.7
21	**C** They're fond with dogs.	fond takes **of**, not with. The others are correct.	§2.7
22	**B** The	a mountain range / mountains in general as a place → *the* mountains.	§2.10
23	**B** An	*emergency* starts with a vowel sound → an.	§2.10
24	**C** The	superlative *best* → the.	§2.10
25	**C** The	only one Sun → the.	§2.10
26	**B** "Hour" begins with a vowel sound	Articles follow the first **sound**; hour starts with a vowel sound.	§2.10
27	**C** Ouch	pain → Ouch.	§2.9
28	**B** Er…	hesitation → Er…	§2.9

WEEK 2 · REVISION

Everything in Week 2, on one page

One question per word: what job is it doing here?

R

1 The eight jobs

Noun	names — Arjun, love, swimming pool
Pronoun	replaces a noun — he, it, their
Verb	action/state; only verbs take tense
Adjective	describes noun — opinion → size → colour → type
Adverb	how / when / where / how often / how much
Preposition	at (point) · on (day/surface) · in (period/inside)
Conjunction	FANBOYS · although/unless · either…or
Interjection	Wow! Ouch! Oops! Er…
Article	a/an by first sound · the = specific/unique

2 Traps

SIX TRAPS

1. Same word, different job (*light*). Judge in the sentence.
2. Parliament / table / mountain = concrete; freedom / youth = abstract.
3. *an hour, a university* — sound, not letter.
4. since + point (Monday), for + length (3 days).
5. allergic to · good at · fond of · worried about.
6. No *more clearer*. Group of 3+ → the + -est.

SENTENCE → **Naming** noun · pronoun → **Doing** verb → **Describing** adjective · adverb → **Linking** preposition · conjunction → **Feeling** interjection → **Pointing** a · an · the

HOW WEEK 2 IS TESTED

One sentence, one word: name its **part of speech**, or pick the right **article** or **preposition**. The job of the word, the first **sound** of the noun and fixed partners (*allergic to*) decide the answer.

WEEK 3 · SENTENCES, PHRASES AND IDIOMS

Sentences, Phrases & Idioms

3

Words join into **phrases**, phrases join into **sentences**. This week: word order, subject and predicate, objects, agreement between subject and verb, negatives — and the fixed expressions of English: **idioms**, **phrasal verbs** and **collocations**.

3.1 Words → phrases → sentences

WORD
smallest unit with meaning
student, Chennai, of

→

PHRASE
a group of words that works as **one unit**
the student of English

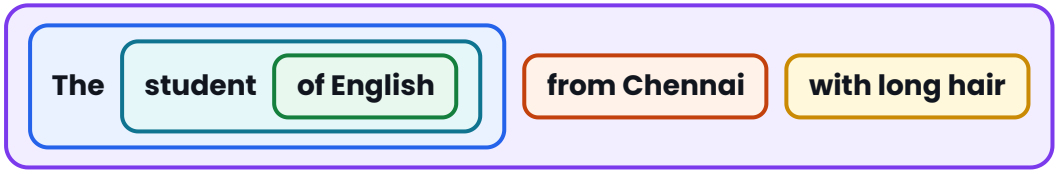
→

CLAUSE
has a subject + a verb
who wore socks and shoes

→

SENTENCE
complete thought, subject + predicate, ends with a full stop
Raju likes books.

Phrases sit **inside** phrases. Each new box adds detail to the head word **student**:



[The [student [of English]]] [from Chennai] [with long hair] — the head comes first, modifiers follow

WORD ORDER IS FIXED IN ENGLISH

✓ The student of English from Chennai
× ~~The student from Chennai of English~~
✓ a costly new Maruti car × ~~new costly Maruti car~~
✓ **has been driving** × ~~been has driving~~

A star * in the lectures marks a wrong (ungrammatical) order.

Kinds of phrase — named after their head word

Noun phrase
the red car — head: car

Verb phrase
has been driving — head: drive

Adjective phrase
very pretty — head: pretty

Adverb phrase
early in the morning

Prepositional phrase
on the table, in a big box

3.2 Subject, predicate and object

SENTENCE

SUBJECT
the doer — answers **who?**
noun or pronoun
Riyad · Ram · I · They

PREDICATE
everything said about the subject — always has the verb
plays cricket every Sunday

Sentence	Subject	Verb	Object (what?)
I want a glass of water.	I	want	a glass of water
He loves his family dearly.	He	loves	his family
Ram killed Raavan.	Ram	killed	Raavan

English is S-V-O; Indian languages are S-O-V

English	**Raju** Subject	**likes** Verb (middle)	**pizza** Object
Hindi	**Raju ko** Subject	**pizza** Object	**pasand hai** Verb (end)

English is **verb-medial**; Hindi, Tamil, Malayalam are **verb-final**. Don't carry your mother-tongue order into English.

IMPERATIVE SENTENCES HAVE A HIDDEN SUBJECT

(You) sit down. (You) come here. The subject **you** is understood. Add **please** to turn a **command** into a **request**: *Please give me a glass of water.*

3.3 Verbs and their objects

INTRANSITIVE
0 objects
I sleep early. She smiled.

TRANSITIVE
1 object
I like mangoes.

DITRANSITIVE
2 objects
I gave my friend a book.
I teach English to college students.

DIRECT VS INDIRECT OBJECT

Direct object = the thing that receives the action (*what?* → a book).
Indirect object = the person who gets it (*to whom?* → my friend).

3.4 Agreement — subject and verb must match

The verb changes to match the subject in **number** (singular / plural) and **person** (1st / 2nd / 3rd). Only the **3rd-person singular** takes **-s** in the present.

Person ↓ / Number →	Singular	Plural
1st (speaker)	I **am** · I like**-0**	We **are** · we like**-0**
2nd (listener)	You **are** · you like**-0**	You **are** · you like**-0**
3rd (others)	He/She/It **is** · he like**s**	They **are** · they like**-0**

NEGATIVES FOLLOW THE SAME RULE

John likes pizza → John **does not** like pizza.
They like pizza → They **do not** like pizza.
He is a teacher → He is **not** a teacher.
(You) come here → **Do not (Don't)** come here.
After does/do/did the verb goes back to the base form: ~~does not likes~~.

Rule	Example (from PYQs)
A and B → plural	Both the book and the pen **are** on the table.
A as well as / along with / including B → agrees with **A**	The teacher, as well as the students, **is** … The moon, as well as the stars, **gives** us light.
either…or / neither…nor → agrees with the **nearer** one	Either my mother or my father **is** coming.
one of / none of / each / no one → singular	None of the chairs **needs** repair. No one **gets** attention.
money, distance, time as one amount → singular	Thousand rupees **is** the fine. 200 cm **is** equal to 2 m.
a majority of / collective as one body → singular	A majority of the city **is** unaware.
pair nouns → plural	Do these scissors **get** rusty?
sheep, deer → follow the meaning	The deer **is** a herbivore. The sheep **are** of a breed…
There + verb + noun → noun decides	There **are** a hundred people here.

EXAM METHOD

Cross out everything between the subject and the verb (*as well as the students*, *with all the birds*, *including the previews*). Then match the verb to the real subject that is left.

3.5 Fixed expressions: the phrase family

PHRASE
any group of words with a special meaning
all rights reserved

IDIOM
meaning is **not** the literal sum of the words
kick the bucket = die

PROVERB
short traditional saying with a truth
Every cloud has a silver lining

SAYING
memorable expression
All that glitters is not gold

EUPHEMISM
polite word for something upsetting
passed away = died

Idiom	Meaning
A dark horse	an unexpected winner
Bite the bullet	face something hard bravely
Break the ice	remove tension at a first meeting
Cut corners	do it the fastest, cheapest way
Get out of hand	become difficult to control
Cost an arm and a leg	be very expensive
Keep in the loop	keep someone updated
Out of the loop	not informed
Ring a bell	sound familiar
Throw in the towel	give up
Blow off steam	release stress or anger
Through thick and thin	in good and bad times
Face the music	accept the punishment
Out of my league	too good / not at my level

Idiom	Meaning
In the clear	not guilty; free from danger
A piece of cake	very easy
Once in a blue moon	very rarely
At the eleventh hour	at the last moment
Miss the boat	lose a chance
Beat around the bush	avoid the main point
Not my cup of tea	not what I like
Live from hand to mouth	have just enough to survive
Give a run for his money	give a strong competition
Find one's feet	become comfortable in a new place
White elephant	costly but useless thing
Crocodile tears	false tears
Sit on the fence	not take sides
Burn the candle at both ends	work extremely hard

Idioms from the lectures and from real IITM papers. Learn the picture behind each one — it sticks better than the words.

3.6 Phrasal verbs — verb + small word = new meaning

give + *up* = **give up** (stop trying). The particle changes the meaning completely, so learn each phrasal verb as a new word.

SEPARABLE

the object can go **between** the verb and the particle

sum up the points → sum them up · call by · turn off · bring up

INSEPARABLE

the object always comes **after** the whole phrase

come across · run into · take after · look into · live on · stand for · hit on · keep at · see about

Phrasal verb	Meaning
back out	withdraw from a promise
hold onto	keep firmly (beliefs)
hold off	keep an enemy away; delay
break down	lose control of feelings; stop working
break up	end (a meeting); separate
break out	start suddenly (war, fire)
bring up	raise a child
wait on	serve somebody
lay off	stop doing; dismiss workers
come across	find by chance

3.7 Words that go together — collocations

Native speakers say **strong coffee**, not *powerful coffee*. Such natural pairs are **collocations**. Matching questions test them every paper.

weather forecast	unanimous decision	land acquisition
moral decay	final blow	bank account
strong coffee	short temper	lazy afternoon
ancient ruins	job offer	library card
garden hose	fishing rod	sports equipment

Small words that confuse	Rule
a few / few	**a few** = some (positive): *a few grains of sand*; few = almost none
little / a little	same idea for uncountable: *a little water*
affect / effect	**affect** = verb (*The storm affected the coast*); effect = noun
to / too / two	**too** = more than enough (*too many people*)

Week 3 · Real PYQs (most repeated first)

28 questions from official IITM papers. Agreement and idioms are the big two; collocation matching (5 marks) appears in almost every qualifier.

1 **Fill in the blank with an appropriate verb.**
The teacher, as well as the students, _____responsible for the agitation in the school campus.

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 14× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Are
- B. Is
- C. Shall
- D. Were

2 **Choose the correct sentence that demonstrates proper subject verb agreement**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 14× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Both the book and the pen is on the table.
- B. Both the book and the pen are on the table.
- C. Both the book and the pen be on the table.
- D. Both the book and the pen am on the table.

3 **Thousand rupees _____ the fine for that traffic violation.**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 14× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Is
- B. Will
- C. Were
- D. Are

4 **Choose the correct sentence that demonstrates proper subject verb agreement**

End Term · Apr 2025 TYPE SEEN 14× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. None of the chairs in the room needs repair.
- B. None of the chair in the room need repair.
- C. None of the chairs in the room is need repair.
- D. None of the chairs in the room are need repair.

5 **Choose the correct option.**
A majority of the city _____ unaware of the events.

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 14× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Is
- B. Will
- C. Were not
- D. Were

6 **Choose the grammatically correct sentence from the given options .**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 14× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. The moon, as well as the stars, give us light.
- B. The moon, as well as the stars, gives us light.

7 **Do these scissors _____ rusty?**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 14× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Gets
- B. Are
- C. Get
- D. Was
- E. Is

8 **Pick the right meaning of the following idiom:**
A dark horse

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. A person who is slightly eccentric
- B. A person who seems to be stupid
- C. An unexpected winner

9 **Consider the following sentence:**
The party was a little slow at first but Kate broke the ice by offering everyone wine and beer. The phrase 'broke the ice' means ___.

Qualifier · Sep 2023 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. To remove the tension at a first meeting
- B. To tell the truth about something that was kept a secret

10 **'The new iPhone seems to cost everyone not just an arm and a leg, but also a kidney.'**
What does 'to cost an arm and a leg' mean?

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. To be very expensive
- B. To be very short-lived
- C. To be very cheap
- D. To be afraid of surgery

11 **A colleague in your office tells you, 'Please keep me <u>in the loop</u> while I'm on my vacation.' What does the underlined part mean?**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 6× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** The colleague wants you not to disturb them.
- **B.** The colleague wants you to call them.
- **C.** The colleague wants you to keep them updated on events at work.
- **D.** The colleague wants you to call them for your wedding.

12 **Fill in the blank with the most appropriate phrase/idiom corresponding to the meaning provided. He disliked having to confront his father, but he knew that he would just have to _____. Intended meaning: To force yourself to do something difficult or unpleasant and face the consequences, or to be brave in a difficult situation.**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 3× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Beat a dead horse
- **B.** Miss the boat
- **C.** Bite the bullet
- **D.** Zip his lip

13 **"Kathy Stevens." Does the name _____?**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 10× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Threw in the towel
- **B.** Face the music
- **C.** Through thick and thin
- **D.** Ring a bell
- **E.** Blow off some steam

14 **For several years, he was trying unsuccessfully to emigrate to the UAE, but eventually he _____.**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 10× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Threw in the towel
- **B.** Face the music
- **C.** Through thick and thin
- **D.** Ring a bell
- **E.** Blow off some steam

15 **Make sure that you have sufficient attendance in your courses, or you will have to _____.**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 10× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Threw in the towel
- **B.** Face the music
- **C.** Through thick and thin
- **D.** Ring a bell
- **E.** Blow off some steam

16 **Identify the underlined part of the sentence.**
I <u>came across</u> some old books while tidying my room.

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Separable phrasal verb
- **B.** In-separable phrasal verb

17 **Identify the separable phrasal verb out of the following options.**

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Live on
- **B.** See about
- **C.** Take after
- **D.** Sum up

18 **"Run into" is an example of an inseparable phrasal verb.**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** TRUE
- **B.** FALSE

19 **Fill in the blank with the appropriate option.**
The kids were well _____.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Got off
- **B.** Gave up
- **C.** Brought up
- **D.** Pick up

20 **Fill in the blank with the most suitable phrasal verb.**
The culprit, overwhelmed by guilt, _____ in front of the jury.

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Broke down
- **B.** Broke apart
- **C.** Broke up
- **D.** Broke out

21 **Replace the bold word in the sentence with one of the phrasal verbs given below to convey the same meaning.**
He promised to contribute towards the fund but later withdrew.

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Backed out
- **B.** Backed on
- **C.** Backed away
- **D.** Backed off

22 **Match the collocation: Bank ___**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 15× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Temper
- **B.** Account
- **C.** Ruins
- **D.** Afternoon
- **E.** Coffee

23 **Match the collocation: Strong ___**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 15× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Temper
- **B.** Account
- **C.** Ruins
- **D.** Afternoon
- **E.** Coffee

24 **Match the collocation: Lazy ___**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 15× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Temper
- **B.** Account
- **C.** Ruins
- **D.** Afternoon
- **E.** Coffee

25 **Match the collocation: Short ___**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 15× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Temper
- **B.** Account
- **C.** Ruins
- **D.** Afternoon
- **E.** Coffee

26 **Match the collocation: Ancient ___**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 15× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Temper
- **B.** Account
- **C.** Ruins
- **D.** Afternoon
- **E.** Coffee

27 **There are ___ grains of sand in the box.**

Quiz 1 · Oct 2025 SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Few
- **B.** A few
- **C.** Little
- **D.** Some

28 **Choose the correct option:**
The storm _____ the coast badly.

Qualifier · Jan 2024 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- **A.** Effected
- **B.** Affected
- **C.** Both Effected and Affected
- **D.** None of these

WHY COLLOCATIONS ARE FREE MARKS

The five collocation items always share one list of five answers, and each answer is used once. Do the pairs you are sure of first (*bank account, strong coffee*); the last one is then forced.

Answers & reasons: Week 3

Q	Correct option	Why	See
1	**B** Is	*as well as the students* is extra; real subject = the teacher (singular) → is.	§3.4
2	**B** Both the book and the pen are on the table.	both A and B = two things → plural *are*.	§3.4
3	**A** Is	A sum of money taken as one amount → singular *is*.	§3.4
4	**A** None of the chairs in the room needs repair.	*None of* takes a singular verb here: needs.	§3.4
5	**A** Is	*a majority of the city* — the city as one body → is.	§3.4
6	**B** The moon, as well as the stars, gives us light.	as well as → verb agrees with *the moon* → gives.	§3.4
7	**C** Get	scissors is a pair noun (plural); after *do* use base form → get.	§3.4
8	**C** An unexpected winner	A dark horse = someone who wins against expectations.	§3.5
9	**A** To remove the tension at a first meeting	Kate made people relax → broke the ice.	§3.5
10	**A** To be very expensive	cost an arm and a leg = very expensive.	§3.5
11	**C** The colleague wants you to keep them updated on events at work.	in the loop = informed, kept updated.	§3.5
12	**C** Bite the bullet	Face something hard bravely = bite the bullet.	§3.5
13	**D** Ring a bell	Does the name sound familiar? → ring a bell.	§3.5
14	**A** Threw in the towel	Tried for years, then gave up → threw in the towel.	§3.5
15	**B** Face the music	Accept the bad result → face the music.	§3.5
16	**B** In-separable phrasal verb	come across (find by chance) cannot be split → inseparable.	§3.6
17	**D** Sum up	sum up → sum *it* up. The others cannot be split.	§3.6
18	**A** TRUE	We say *run into a friend*, never *run a friend into*.	§3.6
19	**C** Brought up	raised well → brought up.	§3.6
20	**A** Broke down	overwhelmed by guilt, lost control → broke down.	§3.6
21	**A** Backed out	withdrew from a promise → backed out.	§3.6
22	**B** Account	bank account	§3.7
23	**E** Coffee	strong coffee	§3.7
24	**D** Afternoon	lazy afternoon	§3.7
25	**A** Temper	short temper	§3.7
26	**C** Ruins	ancient ruins	§3.7
27	**B** A few	a few = some (countable grains), positive meaning.	§3.7
28	**B** Affected	affect is the verb; effect is the noun.	§3.7

WEEK 3 · REVISION

Everything in Week 3, on one page

Sentence shape, agreement rules and the fixed expressions you must know.

R

1 Core ideas

Phrase	group of words = one unit; head first, modifiers after
Sentence	subject + predicate; English is S-V-O
Imperative	hidden subject *you*; please = request
Objects	intransitive 0 · transitive 1 · ditransitive 2 (DO + IO)
Agreement	3rd person singular → -s / is / has / does
Idiom	meaning not literal — dark horse, break the ice
Phrasal verb	separable (sum it up) vs inseparable (run into)
Collocation	natural pair — strong coffee, weather forecast

2 Agreement in six lines

RULES

1. A **and** B → plural.
2. A **as well as / with / including** B → follow A.
3. either/neither…or/nor → follow the nearer subject.
4. one of, none of, each, no one → singular.
5. one amount of money / distance / time → singular.
6. scissors, trousers → plural; sheep, deer → by meaning.

WORDS → **Phrases** noun · verb · prep… → **Sentence** S + V + O → **Agreement** number × person → **Negation** do/does + not → **Fixed expressions** idioms · phrasal verbs · collocations

HOW WEEK 3 IS TESTED

Pick the verb that agrees; pick the idiom's meaning or fill a blank from an idiom list; say if a phrasal verb is separable; match collocations or synonyms. Read the **whole** sentence — the context gives away idioms.

WEEK 4 · SPEAKING SKILLS — SPOKEN ENGLISH PRELIMINARIES

Spoken English Basics

4

How to speak so that people understand you: politeness, slow tempo and pauses; why native speakers are hard to follow; how speech sounds are produced; **word stress**, **aspiration**; and polite **telephone English** — a block in every paper.

4.1 Three golden rules of speaking

1. Have something to say
Clear ideas first. Words follow ideas.

+

2. Politeness beats grammar
Politeness matters more than perfect pronunciation or grammar.

+

3. Slow tempo = politeness
English is a slow-tempo language. Slow speech is easy to follow and gives you time to think.

› Pause is the punctuation of speech

Speakers of English pause after each **phrase**, **clause** and **sentence**. Where you pause can change the meaning:

A woman, without her man, is nothing.
the woman needs the man

≠

A woman: without her, man is nothing.
the man needs the woman

Same words, different pause, opposite meaning

WHY FAST SPEECH FAILS

Rapid speech makes sounds **merge**, some sounds **drop**, others **change shape** — the listener loses the words. Slow speech is clearer, more polite, and lets you pick the right word.

Try it: record one minute on a topic, count the words; then record again speaking slowly. Ask a friend which one was clearer.

GOOD SPOKEN ENGLISH IS A PRODUCT OF GOOD LISTENING

You cannot speak what you have not heard. Every rule in this week starts with listening carefully.

4.2 Why native speakers are hard to understand

ACCENT
English is global — many accents. Non-native speakers outnumber native ones; mother tongues colour English.

SPEED → REDUCTIONS
Fast speech squeezes words:
gonna going to · **wanna** want to · **kinda** kind of · **shoulda** should have · **coulda** could have

CONTRACTIONS
I'll I will · **you'll** you will · **we're** we are · **can't** cannot · **won't** will not

VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR
Long sentences and rare words (*conspicuous, rendering*) slow understanding.

How to listen well in a conversation

Relax & focus → **Don't translate** into your mother tongue in your head → **Catch the context** hotel? bank? doctor?

Choose material at the right level

below 50% — too hard	50–90% understood — learn here	too easy

Pick audio where you understand more than 50% but less than 90%

Source	Why it helps
News (BBC, CNN, Indian English channels)	clear, standard speech
Radio & podcasts	free, daily, many accents
Movies — no subtitles	real speed, real reductions
TV shows	longer than movies, same voices
Songs	repetition
Audiobooks, TED talks	well-produced, good for practice
Talk to friends in English	turn listening into speaking

Listen to men, women and children; to different varieties; something every day.

4.3 How speech is produced

LUNGS
push air out — the power source

→

GLOTTIS (vocal cords)
wide open → no voice (whisper, /s/ /h/)
vibrating → voice (/z/, all vowels)
shut → no air, no speech

→

PHARYNX
the throat tube — little happens here

→

UVULA (gate)
raised → air through mouth (oral)
lowered → some air through nose (nasal: m, n, ŋ)

→

MOUTH
tongue, lips and jaw shape the final sound

The speech chain — every sound you make passes through these five stations

	Vowels	Consonants
Air	flows freely — no obstruction	blocked or squeezed somewhere
Voice	always voiced	voiced (b d g v z) or voiceless (p t k f s)
Shaped by	lip shape, jaw opening, tongue height	place + manner of blocking
Special	/w/ and /y/ are made without blocking but count as consonants	

ENGLISH VOWELS ARE DIFFERENT

- Standard British English has **20 vowel sounds** (American has 1–2 fewer).
- At least **12 long vowels** — Hindi has barely 6–7.
- English long vowels are **very long** — nearly twice an Indian long vowel.
- **Diphthongs** are extra-long (XL) vowels: *bite, bout, boat, bait*.
- Long vs short makes **minimal pairs**: *pill / peel, pit / part*.

VOICED VS VOICELESS — SAY THESE PAIRS

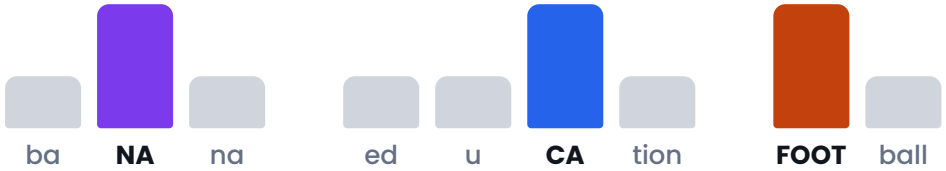
simple / symbol · *temple / tumble* · *uncle / angle* — the first has a voiceless p/k, the second a voiced b/g. Mixing them changes the word.

V VS W — A COMMON INDIAN ERROR

v (van, ever, move): lower lip touches upper teeth, friction.
w (wan, wet, queen, quick): round the lips like the *u* in *put* — no teeth.

4.4 Word stress — one syllable is the star

In every word of two or more syllables, **one syllable is louder, longer and higher** than the rest. That is the **stressed** syllable. In English the gap between stressed and unstressed syllables is **much bigger** than in Indian languages — so wrong stress makes a word hard to recognise.



Bar height = force of the voice. Dictionaries mark the stressed syllable with ' before it: ba'nana

Language	Where is the stress?	Example
French	always the **last** syllable	Pa'ris
Tamil	usually the **first** syllable	'Rajendran
Hindi	on or **near the last** syllable	Ra'jendran
English	**not fixed** — first, middle or last	'India · Ja'pan · adminis'tration

TWO HELPFUL PATTERNS

A syllable with a **long vowel** is often stressed: *a'go, a'way, de'lay, de'ny.*
A vowel followed by **two consonants** is often stressed: *a'fford, ac'count, at'tend, con'straint.*

The stress rules examiners use

2-syllable nouns & adjectives → 1st
TI-ger · **HAP**-py · **PRE**-sent (gift) · **RAI**-ny

2-syllable verbs & prepositions → 2nd
re-**LAX** · be-**GIN** · pre-**SENT** (to give) · a-**MONG**

Compound nouns → 1st part
FOOTball · **BOOK**shop · **SEA**food · **TOOTH**paste

Compound adjectives → 2nd part
ice-**COLD** · rock-**SOLID**

-tion -sion -cian -ic -ity -ical → just before
limi-**TA**-tion · tech-**NI**-cian · va-**LI**-di-ty · re-a-**LIS**-tic

-ee -eer -ese -ique → on the suffix
guaran-**TEE** · engi-**NEER** · Chi-**NESE** · u-**NIQUE**

› Same spelling, different job → different stress

Word	Noun / adjective (1st)	Verb (2nd)
rebel	a **RE**bel (Jane was a rebel)	to re**BEL**
decrease	a **DE**crease in price	to de**CREASE**
protest	the **PRO**test site	to pro**TEST**
object	an **OB**ject	to ob**JECT**
present	a **PRE**sent	to pre**SENT**
record	a **RE**cord	to re**CORD**

EXAM METHOD

Find the word's **job** in the sentence first (Week 2!). After *a / an / the* → it is a noun → stress the **first** syllable. After *to / will / can* → verb → stress the **second**.

WHEN IN DOUBT, DO NOT STRESS

It is better to stress nothing than to stress the wrong syllable. Prefixes are usually unstressed (except words like **IN**side, **PRE**cede).

4.5 Aspiration — the puff of air after p, t, k

Hold a thin paper in front of your mouth and say **pin**, then **spin**. In *pin* the paper moves — a puff of air follows the /p/. That puff is **aspiration**, written [pʰ]. Only the voiceless stops **p, t, k** can be aspirated.

pin · top · cat
p / t / k at the start of a word
ASPIRATED [pʰ tʰ kʰ]

→

spin · stop · scar
p / t / k right after **s**
NOT aspirated

Rule	Examples
Start of a word → **aspirated**	**p**eople (first p), **c**apital, **p**inch, **p**assive
Start of a **stressed** syllable → **aspirated**	in**t**end, in**t**rude, in**c**ulcate
After **s** → never aspirated	**s**pin, **s**tove, **s**car, **s**pelling, **s**pirit
Unstressed syllable / end of word → not aspirated	peo**p**le (second p), passiona**t**e
Voiced b, d, g → **never** aspirated	bin, dog, go

4.6 Telephone English — polite and clear

Almost every IITM English paper has a **five-blank telephone conversation** (5 marks) — all four qualifiers had one. The right option is always the **polite, complete and relevant** one.

1. Greet — Good afternoon, Verma Enterprises. →

2. Identify — May I ask who is speaking? →

3. Purpose — How may I help you today? →

4. Details — Could you please speak up? →

5. Close — Thank you for your support. · Bye, Usha.

Situation	Polite ✓	Rude / wrong ×
Opening as receptionist	How may I help you today?	What's your problem?
Asking who is calling	May I ask who is speaking?	Who are you?
Offering something	Would you like to book an appointment?	Are we to / Will you
Line goes silent	Hello! Are you there?	I will talk to you later.
Call dropped	The call got **cut off**.	put off / called off
Could not hear	Could you please **speak up**?	speak out (= give opinion)
Transferring	Please hold while I transfer your call.	Keep quiet! Be on hold, buddy!
Agreeing	Yes, definitely. · Sure, Sneha.	Yeah, whatever! · Wanna…?

THE THREE-STEP METHOD

1. Read the **whole** conversation first.
2. For each blank, read the line **after** it — the reply tells you what was asked. (If the next line repeats a name and age, the blank was *Could you please speak up?*)
3. Remove rude, slang or off-topic options; pick the most polite one left.

TRAP

Options that are grammatically fine but **off-topic** (*My wife is cooking in the kitchen*) or **too casual** (*Yeah, whatever!*) are always wrong.

Week 4 · Real PYQs (most repeated first)

25 questions from official IITM papers: word stress, aspiration and two full telephone conversations. The telephone block alone has appeared **40 times** across papers.

1 **Consider the sentence Jane was a rebel when she was young. The word rebel in this sentence is stressed as _____.**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. **RE**bel
- B. re**BEL**

2 **'Since last month, there has been a decrease in the amount of cereals sold for the same price.' Choose the appropriate stress for the usage of the word 'decrease' in the sentence.**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. DEcrease
- B. deCREASE

3 **'The site of the protest looked bloody and chaotic.'**
Choose the appropriate stress for the usage of the word 'protest' in the sentence.

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. PROtest
- B. proTEST

4 **The word limitation is stressed as _____.**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. 'Limitation
- B. Li'mitation
- C. Limi'tation
- D. Limita'tion

5 **The word constraint is stressed as _____ .**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Con'straint
- B. 'Constraint
- C. Cons'traint
- D. Co'nstraint

6 **The word technician is stressed as _____.**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. 'Technician
- B. Tech'nician
- C. Techni'cian
- D. Te'chnician

7 **The word validity stressed as _____ (stress is indicated in bold)**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 4× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. **VA**lidity
- B. va**LI**dity
- C. vali**DI**ty

8 **The compound word football is stressed on the _____.**

End Term · Apr 2025 TYPE SEEN 2× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. First syllable
- B. Second syllable
- C. No stress

9 **The compound word ice-cold is stressed on the _____.**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 2× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. First syllable
- B. Second syllable
- C. No stress

10 **Which /p/ sound in the word people is aspirated?**

End Term · Dec 2024 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. /p/ in the first syllable
- B. /p/ in the second syllable
- C. Both /p/ sounds are aspirated
- D. No /p/ sounds are aspirated

11 **Which of the following has an aspirated stop?**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Scar
- B. Pinch
- C. Inculcate
- D. Both Pinch and Inculcate

12 **Which of the following has an aspirated stop ?**

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Spelling
- B. Passive
- C. Intend
- D. Both Passive and Intend

13 **Is the /t/ sound (underlined) in the following word aspirated or not?**
Passionate

Quiz 2 · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. Aspirated
- B. Non-aspirated

14 **The /t/ sound in the word stove is aspirated.**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- A. True
- B. False

15 **Which of the following has an aspirated stop?**

End Term · Aug 2025 TYPE SEEN 7× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** Spirit
- ○ **B.** Capital
- ○ **C.** Intrude
- ○ **D.** Both Capital and Intrude

QUALIFIER MAY 2023 · READ, THEN FILL BLANKS (I)–(V) → Q16–20

Harilal Hello! Is this Nirjeevani Hospital?
Receptionist Yes. (i) _____
Harilal I wanted to know if Dr. Arundhati will be available for consultation.
Receptionist Yes Ma'am. (ii) _____ book an appointment?
Harilal Yes, I want to book an appointment
Receptionist Please tell me your name and age. Hello! (iii) _____
(The call gets disconnected)
Harilal Hello!
Receptionist Hello! Nirjeevani Hospital.
Harilal The call got (iv) _____. My name is Harilal Khan and I am 35 years old.
Receptionist Could you please (v) _____
Harilal Harilal Khan, 35 years.
Receptionist Alright. Please be here by 10: 00 a.m. Thank you!

16 **Complete blank (i) with an appropriate response.**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** How may I help you today?
- ○ **B.** Who's calling, please?
- ○ **C.** Hello! Are you Narsimh?

17 **Complete blank (ii) with an appropriate response.**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** Are we to
- ○ **B.** Would you like to
- ○ **C.** Will you

18 **Complete blank (iii) with an appropriate response.**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** Please ring me later.
- ○ **B.** Are you there?
- ○ **C.** I will talk to you later.

19 **Which among the following expressions can complete blank (iv)?**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** Put off
- ○ **B.** Called off
- ○ **C.** Cut off

20 **Which among the following expressions would complete blank (v)?**

Qualifier · May 2023 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** Speak up
- ○ **B.** Speak out
- ○ **C.** Call back

QUALIFIER MAY 2024 · READ, THEN FILL BLANKS (I)–(V) → Q21–25

Jay Hello? (i)_____

Prateek Hello. Yes, I am Prateek Agarwal. (ii)_____

Jay Prateek, it's me Jay Roy from college. Remember?

Prateek Hey Jay, (iii)_____It has been such a long time.

Jay I am doing good. Yes, four long years after college. I got your contact number from Piyush. (iv)_____

Prateek Yes, yes, I do remember him. Wasn't he the one who topped our engineering batch last year?

Jay Yes, that's him! He's in Boston working for a big MNC now.

Prateek (v)_____

21 **Complete blank (i) with an appropriate response.**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** Is this Prateek Agarwal's house?
- ○ **B.** Is this Prateek Agarwal's family?
- ○ **C.** Am I talking to Prateek Agarwal?
- ○ **D.** Is this Prateek Agarwal's son?

22 **Complete blank (ii) with an appropriate response.**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** May I come in?
- ○ **B.** May I drop you home?
- ○ **C.** May I ask who is speaking?
- ○ **D.** May I know why you are here?

23 **Complete blank (iii) with an appropriate response.**

Qualifier · May 2024 TYPE SEEN 40× SINGLE ANSWER

- ○ **A.** Could you bring me the office file?
- ○ **B.** Is it a new project?
- ○ **C.** Where are you going?
- ○ **D.** How are you?

24 **Complete blank (iv) with an appropriate response.**

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- ○ **A.** When will you come home?
- ○ **B.** Do you remember him?
- ○ **C.** Did you have dinner?
- ○ **D.** Did you meet him?

25 **Complete blank (v) with an appropriate response.**

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- ○ **A.** That is amazing news!
- ○ **B.** Thank you!
- ○ **C.** You are welcome!
- ○ **D.** I am sorry!

Answers & reasons: Week 4

Q	Correct option	Why	See
1	**A** REbel	*a rebel* → noun → first syllable stressed.	§4.4
2	**A** DEcrease	*a decrease* → noun → DEcrease.	§4.4
3	**A** PROtest	*the protest* site → noun → PROtest.	§4.4
4	**C** Limi'tation	-tion → stress the syllable just before: limi'TA'tion.	§4.4
5	**A** Con'straint	-straint has a long diphthong and a cluster, so it takes the stress: con'straint.	§4.4
6	**B** Tech'nician	-cian → stress before: tech'nician.	§4.4
7	**B** vaLIdity	-ity → stress before: va'LI'dity.	§4.4
8	**A** First syllable	compound noun → first part: FOOTball.	§4.4
9	**B** Second syllable	compound adjective → second part: ice-COLD.	§4.4
10	**A** /p/ in the first syllable	first p starts the word (and stressed syllable) → aspirated; second p is in an unstressed syllable.	§4.5
11	**D** Both Pinch and Inculcate	scar: k after s → not aspirated. pinch (start), inculcate (stressed -cul-) → aspirated.	§4.5
12	**D** Both Passive and Intend	spelling: p after s → no. passive (start) and intend (stressed -tend) → yes.	§4.5
13	**B** Non-aspirated	t in -nate is in an unstressed syllable → non-aspirated.	§4.5
14	**B** False	t right after s → never aspirated.	§4.5
15	**D** Both Capital and Intrude	spirit: p after s → no. capital (start), intrude (stressed -trude) → yes.	§4.5
16	**A** How may I help you today?	A receptionist opens by offering help.	§4.6
17	**B** Would you like to	Offers use the polite *Would you like to…?*	§4.6
18	**B** Are you there?	The line went quiet → check: Are you there?	§4.6
19	**C** Cut off	A dropped call is *cut off*.	§4.6
20	**A** Speak up	She repeats her name → the receptionist could not hear → speak up.	§4.6
21	**C** Am I talking to Prateek Agarwal?	Jay is checking he has the right person.	§4.6
22	**C** May I ask who is speaking?	Prateek doesn't know the caller → polite: May I ask who is speaking?	§4.6
23	**D** How are you?	Next line: *I am doing good* → the question was How are you?	§4.6
24	**B** Do you remember him?	Next line: *Yes, I do remember him* → Do you remember him?	§4.6
25	**A** That is amazing news!	Piyush's success → That is amazing news!	§4.6

WEEK 4 · REVISION

Everything in Week 4, on one page

Speak slowly, stress right, puff only where English puffs, and stay polite on the phone.

R

1 Core ideas

Golden rules	something to say · politeness · slow tempo
Pause	the punctuation of speech; changes meaning
Reductions	gonna, wanna, kinda, shoulda; contractions I'll, we're
Speech chain	lungs → glottis → pharynx → uvula → mouth/nose
Voice	vocal cords vibrate (z, b, vowels) or not (s, p, h)
Word stress	one syllable louder, longer; not fixed in English
Aspiration	puff after p/t/k at word start or stressed syllable
Telephone	greet → identify → purpose → details → close

2 Stress & aspiration in six lines

RULES

1. 2-syllable noun/adjective → 1st (a REbel); verb → 2nd (to reBEL).
2. Compound noun → 1st (FOOTball); compound adjective → 2nd (ice-COLD).
3. -tion, -cian, -ity, -ic → syllable just before.
4. -ee, -eer, -ese, -ique → on the suffix.
5. p/t/k after s → never aspirated (spin, stove, scar).
6. When in doubt, don't stress.

LISTEN 50–90% material → **Speak slowly** pause at phrases → **Sounds** voice · long vowels → **Stress** one star syllable → **Aspiration** puff on p t k → **Phone** polite + relevant

HOW WEEK 4 IS TESTED

Five telephone blanks in almost **every** paper; noun-or-verb stress, mark-the-stressed-syllable, compound stress and which stop is aspirated in quizzes and end terms. Use the method: **job of the word → rule → answer**.